

O wized eyes resplendent

In memory of Robert Coon (1931 - 2021)

Text: Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

Music: Gustav Holst, 1921

THAXTED 13.13.14.12.13.14

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The melody is accompanied by a series of chords indicated above the staff. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three staves of text. The first system of lyrics is: 1 O wized eyes resplendent, we seek the things you saw, 2 O eager lips of blessing, speak grace for us today, 3 O trembling hands of service, wrap arms around us all. The second system is: that urged you to such greatness, and humbled you in awe. for give us and our mourning, our stubborn, petty ways. Take respite from your labors, and joy in heaven's call. The third system is: We strive now, as you once strove, toward the beacon, toward the Light. We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stories, holy jest, We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plowshare hewn. The fourth system is: With forebears inviting, it beckons yet more bright. to bolster worn hearts and inspire us to our best. Through clangorous war drums you hummed a different tune: The fifth system is: Though tearful eyes may hinder, and sorrow shroud our way, You uttered blessed assurance, through strife, your words did calm, Ev'ry note is one of justice, each tear can shatter chains, The sixth system is: what seems to us like evening may just be break of day. there is a far in Gilead, vouchsafed for us a Balm. ev'ry sigh becomes a rush of wind, set free across the plains.

B E F#7/C# B E F# G#m

1 O wized eyes re - splen - dent, we seek the things you saw,
2 O ea - ger lips of bless - ing, speak grace for us to - day,
3 O trem - b'ling hands of ser - vice, wrap arms a - round us all.

E F#7/C# B Emaj7 C#m B

that urged you to such great - ness, and hum - bled you in awe.
for - give us and our mourn - ing, our stub - born, pet - ty ways.
Take res - pite from your la - bors, and joy in heav - en's call.

F# G#m F# B F# B E

We strive now, as you once strove, toward the bea - con, toward the Light.
We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stor - ies, ho - ly jest,
We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plow - share hewn.

G#m E B C#m/E G#m F#

With fore - bears in - vit - ing, it beck - ons yet more bright.
to bol - ster worn hearts and in - spire us to our best.
Through clang - or - ous war drums you hummed a dif - f'rent tune:

E F#7/C# B/D# E F# G#m

Though tear - y eyes may hin - der, and sor - row shroud our way,
You ut - tered bless'd ass - ur - ance, through strife, your words did calm,
Ev - 'ry note is one of jus - tice, each tear can shat - ter chains,

E F#7/C# B Emaj7 C#m B

what seems to us like eve - ning may just be break of day.
there is a - far in Gi - le - ad, vouch - safed for us a Balm.
ev - 'ry sigh be - comes a rush of wind, set free a - cross the plains.